

Dear Raquel,

Thank you for your message and for the opportunity to further detail Zura Touch.

Project Description

The goal of the project is to reinvent traditional vending by turning machines into more attractive, digital, and engaging points of sale.

Today's vending industry still has several gaps: limited access to essential products in specific situations (especially at night), low user engagement in public spaces, and a lack of technological innovation in most machines.

In the initial phase, we are deploying existing vending machines to validate demand and better understand user behavior, while building early traction. These machines will offer a curated mix of essential and impulse-driven products (such as hygiene items, portable chargers, novelty products, mystery boxes, and disposable cameras), targeting moments where convenience is key and traditional retail is not available—particularly in nightlife environments.

Over time, our goal is to go beyond product sales by developing a software layer that integrates advertising, gamification, and user interaction. This will turn vending machines into digital, data-driven platforms, increasing both engagement and conversion rates. Ultimately, we aim to offer integrated vending solutions (hardware + software) that can be deployed through revenue-sharing, leasing, or as scalable B2B solutions.

Overall, the solution contributes to modernizing public spaces and advancing the digitalization of automated retail.

Market Strategy

We are initially targeting nightlife venues and high-density urban environments, where consumer behavior is highly impulsive and driven by convenience.

Our market entry strategy is focused on quickly deploying existing vending machines in strategic locations to capture real demand and leverage impulse-driven consumption patterns. This allows us to build initial traction while gaining direct insights into user behavior and product performance.

Based on this, we will continuously optimize product selection, pricing, and placement to maximize revenue per location.

As the business evolves, we will introduce a proprietary software layer (advertising, gamification, and user interaction) to increase engagement and unlock additional revenue streams.

In the long term, we aim to scale the model through leasing, franchising, and B2B vending solutions, expanding both geographically and through partnerships with operators and brands.

We will initially adopt a revenue-share model with venue partners, enabling fast deployment with no upfront cost and aligning incentives while securing high-quality locations.

Traction & Growth

Zura Touch is currently in the pre-deployment phase, with a defined roadmap for pilot, validation, and expansion.

We have been selected for the StartUP Voucher program, through which we are developing the business, structuring the pilot, and refining the concept with financial support and mentorship.

We are preparing the launch of the first machines and are in contact with potential venue partners for pilot installations.

Based on our initial analysis, we estimate that well-performing machines in high-traffic locations can generate up to €5,000 in monthly revenue, with product margins around 30%.

In addition, we see strong potential for additional revenue through digital advertising, which we expect to develop progressively as the network scales.

The founding team combines complementary expertise in mechanical and software engineering. I hold a Master's degree in Mechanical Engineering from FEUP, and my co-founder is currently studying Computer Engineering, at ISEP.

We believe Zura Touch is at a stage where incubation would significantly accelerate execution, particularly in building partnerships and scaling the business.

At this stage, our priority is to focus resources on product development and market validation, keeping operational costs as lean as possible. For this reason, we are currently more interested in incubation support than in additional structured programs, as the Schools of Startups.

Thank you once again for your consideration.

Kind regards,
Diogo Gomes
Zura Touch